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PEOPLE'S FREE CLINIC DEMANDS REBUTTAL FOR SICKLE CELL SLUR

(Berkeley, Calif.) - In a press release distributed Friday, October 31, the People's Free Health Clinic has demanded rebuttal time from KPIX-TV, Channel 5, in San Francisco for the station's vicious attack on the credibility of the Clinic's solicitation and testing program for Sickle Cell Anemia.

The Sickle Cell Anemia program of the People's Free Medical Clinic is sponsored by the Son of Man Temple, a community-based church in East Oakland. Soliciting for the program is done by unpaid volunteers who contribute their time in an effort to fight Sickle Cell Anemia, a deadly blood disease primarily affecting Black Americans.

The People's Free Medical Clinic — which provides numerous other health services free of charge to the community — has since 1969 tested over 45,000 Bay Area residents for Sickle Cell Anemia and through affiliated Clinics over 500,000 people nationwide.

Explaining the Clinic's Sickle Cell Anemia program, Clinic Director Henry Smith said:

"Our program is run primarily (80 per cent) on contributions from the public. These contributions are used for testing and research, not administrative salaries. Due to public's understanding of the deadliness of Sickle Cell Anemia and the vital role of the Clinic in testing and researching this disease — for which medical science has not yet found a cure — we have achieved a significant level of success in fund raising for Sickle Cell Anemia."

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Funds donated to the People's Free Medical Clinic's Sickle Cell Anemia Research Foundation (left) have provided for free testing for over 500,000 people nationwide. Right photo shows Clinic director HENRY SMITH providing this free medical service.



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